

GOOGLE ADS · PERFORMANCE REPORT

Vic. Haulage Co. Campaign Update

Month-on-month performance across April–September 2026. We bought more traffic at a slightly cheaper click — but it converted less well, so leads slipped again and cost per lead rose sharply. The local strategy still works; the money drifted away from it.

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Performance snapshot

September 2026 — across both search campaigns. Spend went back up, reach grew, and clicks got cheaper. The problem is what happened after the click.

CONVERSIONS 38 ▼ down 7% vs Aug Second fall in a row	CLICK-THROUGH RATE 7.48% ▼ down from 7.73% Still second-best on record	COST / LEAD \$57.01 ▲ up 24% vs Aug Dearest since April	SPEND \$2,166 Sep 2026 Up 15% on August
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The headline, stated plainly: **we spent 15% more and got 7% fewer leads**. Cost per lead went from \$45.91 to \$57.01 — a 24% increase and the dearest month since April. This is the account's weakest month on efficiency since the current structure was put in place.

What did *not* go wrong is the traffic. Impressions rose 23% to 1,886 and clicks rose 18% to 141, while the average cost per click actually **fell** from \$15.82 to \$15.36 — the first decline in four months. We bought more, and we bought it slightly cheaper.

The gap sits entirely in conversion rate, which fell from **34.45% to 26.95%**. Two identifiable things account for most of it: the Yarra Valley campaign spent \$369.95 in six serving days for 2.5 leads before being paused on 07/09/2026, and the broad "melbourne / near me" half of the account took a larger share of the budget than in August while getting dearer per lead.

Month-on-month breakdown

April's high impressions came from a Performance Max campaign since paused. Since then the account has run as focused search. September breaks a clear pattern: it is the first month in which spend rose and leads fell at the same time.

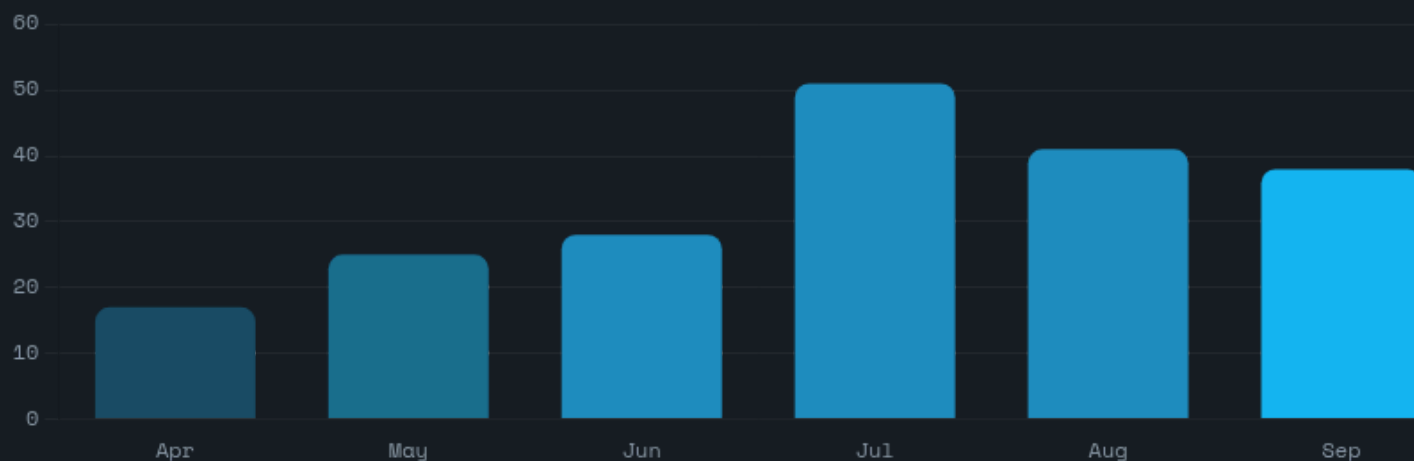
Metric	APR	MAY	JUN	JUL	AUG	SEP
Impressions	66,319	12,907	2,074	2,391	1,539	1,886
Clicks	386	339	132	151	119	141
Conversions	17	25	28	51	41	38
Conversion rate	4.4%	7.4%	21.2%	33.8%	34.5%	27.0%
CTR	0.58%	2.63%	6.36%	6.32%	7.73%	7.48%
Avg. CPC	\$4.03	\$3.20	\$11.57	\$14.70	\$15.82	\$15.36
Cost	\$1,553.92	\$1,083.59	\$1,527.69	\$2,219.63	\$1,882.14	\$2,166.27
Cost / conversion	\$91.41	\$43.34	\$54.56	\$43.52	\$45.91	\$57.01

August's figures are final and have not moved since last month's report — 41 conversions and \$1,882.14, exactly as published. September's figures were pulled on 03/10/2026, after the month had closed, so unlike the July and August reports they are settled numbers rather than month-end estimates and should not shift materially.

Trends & charts

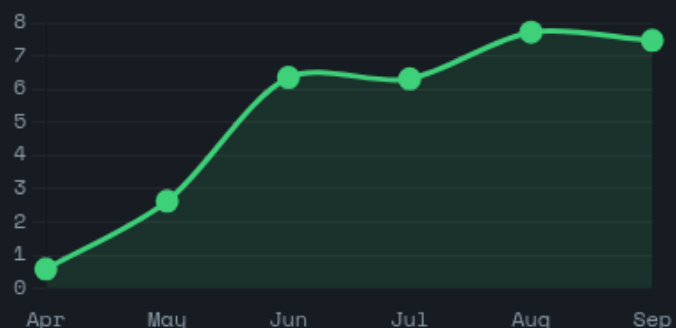
The shape of the story: volume recovering, efficiency going the other way.

Conversions per month



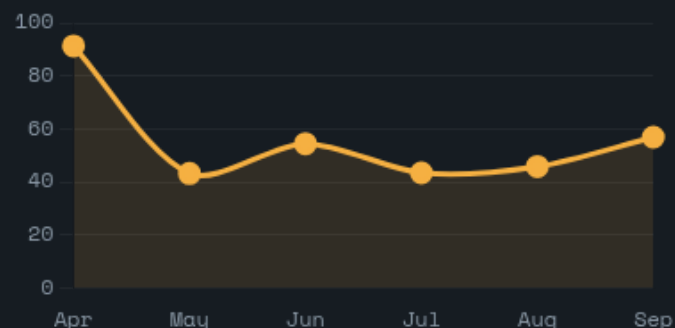
17 → 25 → 28 → 51 → 41 → 38. A second consecutive decline, this time on 15% more spend.

Click-through rate (%)



7.48% — off August's 7.73% record, but still the second-best month the account has run.

Cost per conversion (\$)



\$57.01 — up \$11.10 on August and the dearest since April's \$91.41.

Keywords doing the heavy lifting

The signal has not changed in four months: **local town names win**. What changed in September is the mix — broad metro terms took back a larger share of the budget, and that is most of the reason cost per lead jumped.

Local town & Yarra Valley terms

\$45.58

per lead · 21.5 leads from \$980.04 spend

Broad "melbourne / near me" terms

\$71.89

per lead · 16.5 leads from \$1,186.23 spend

Local terms took **45% of the spend and returned 57% of the leads** — still comfortably the better half, and broad terms are still 58% dearer per lead. But in August local was 47% of spend at \$37.13 a lead. Both halves got dearer, and the balance tipped slightly the wrong way. Local engagement remains in a different league: **13.3% CTR against 5.3%** for broad terms.

KEYWORD	MATCH	QS	CONV	COST	COST / LEAD	CTR
yarra valley towing ★	Broad	5	9.67	\$256.47	\$26.53	25.6%
towing service melbourne	Broad	7	8.00	\$516.61	\$64.58	6.2%
car towing service near me △	Broad	5	6.00	\$460.70	\$76.78	5.2%
towing yarra glen ★	Exact + Broad	—	2.83	\$136.54	\$48.19	16.4%
yarra valley towing healesville △	Broad + Exact	—	2.00	\$263.24	\$131.62	5.8%
pakenham towing	Broad	5	2.00	\$119.93	\$59.96	19.5%
tow truck pakenham ★	Exact	7	2.00	\$52.60	\$26.30	8.3%
tow truck near me △	Exact	5	1.50	\$146.46	\$97.64	6.4%
tow truck prices near me	Broad	—	1.00	\$48.97	\$48.97	2.9%
towing pakenham	Exact	7	1.00	\$36.82	\$36.82	10.5%
tow truck healesville ★	Exact	7	1.00	\$11.16	\$11.16	8.3%

KEYWORD	MATCH	QS	CONV	COST	COST / LEAD	CTR
towing lilydale ★	Exact	7	1.00	\$10.60	\$10.60	25.0%
tow truck yarra valley	Exact	—	0.00	\$41.24	—	n/a
tow truck lilydale	Exact	7	0.00	\$20.96	—	10.0%
towing healesville	Exact	7	0.00	\$17.28	—	25.0%
tow trucks near me ▲	Exact	5	0.00	\$13.49	—	2.6%
towing croydon	Exact	8	0.00	\$13.21	—	16.7%

Figures combine both campaigns where the same keyword ran in each. Quality Score is a live account setting rather than a historical metric, so the column shows the score as it stands today (03/10/2026) — it is not a September average and cannot be compared month on month. A dash means Google has not yet assigned a score. Google reported 2 clicks against 1 impression on tow truck yarra valley, so no meaningful CTR can be shown for that row.

★ **"yarra valley towing" carried the month again**
9.67 of the month's 38 leads at \$26.53 each, from 12% of the spend and a 25.6% click-through rate. It is the fourth month running that this single term has been the most efficient lead source in the account.

🎯 **The cheapest leads were all suburb terms**
"towing lilydale" \$10.60, "tow truck healesville" \$11.16, "tow truck pakenham" \$26.30. Every lead that cost under \$30 came from a term naming a town. Not one came from a broad metro term.

📈 **"towing service melbourne" improved markedly**
Still the biggest single line of spend at \$516.61, but cost per lead fell from \$71.60 to \$64.58 and CTR nearly doubled from 3.6% to 6.2%. The ad and keyword work on it is clearly landing. It is still dearer than every local term in the table.

📉 **"car towing service near me" went backwards badly**
\$460.70 for 6 leads — \$76.78 each, against \$43.50 in August on slightly less spend. It is now the account's worst lead cost at volume. Google rates its landing page experience **below average**, the only keyword in the account carrying that flag, which both raises its click cost and points at where the fix is.

📦 **"yarra valley towing healesville" cost \$263.24 for 2 leads**
\$131.62 a lead — the single worst line in the month, and jarring given that plain "yarra valley towing" delivered at \$26.53. Almost all of it (\$253.69) was the broad-match version in the Yarra Valley campaign, where it drew a 5.0% CTR against 25.6% for the main campaign's version.

1 2 3 4 **Three of the four biggest-spending keywords sit at Quality Score 5**

"car towing service near me", "yarra valley towing" and "tow truck near me" are all on 5 today; "towing service melbourne" is on 7. By contrast "towing croydon" and "tow truck croydon" sit on 8. Every point of Quality Score is a discount on the click price, so the account's largest costs are also where it is paying the biggest penalty.

05 · WINS

The wins 🏆



The weekend blackout is fixed

Last month's report flagged seven dark days, including every Sunday. In September the ads ran on

29 of 30 days

— the only day with no impressions at all was Sunday 06/09/2026. That was the clearest volume opportunity in the account and it has been closed.



Average cost per click fell for the first time in four months

\$15.82 → \$15.36. After three consecutive rises this is a genuine break in the trend, and it means the budget is buying more clicks per dollar than it did in August.



Reach grew again after three months of shrinking

Impressions up 23% to 1,886 and clicks up 18% to 141 — the first increase in either since June. The account is no longer contracting.



The local strategy keeps proving itself

\$45.58 per lead against \$71.89 for broad metro terms, and 13.3% CTR against 5.3%. Local terms returned 57% of the leads from 45% of the spend. The case for pushing further in this direction is now four months deep.

Worth watching



Cost per lead rose 24% to \$57.01

The honest read: this is the account's weakest efficiency month since April. Conversion rate fell from 34.45% to 26.95%, which is where the entire deterioration sits — click costs went down, not up. Two months ago the account was at \$43.52 a lead. Getting back under \$50 is the priority for October.



The Yarra Valley campaign was expensive and is now paused

It spent

\$369.95 in six serving days

(01/09–05/09 and 07/09) for 2.5 leads —

\$147.98 each

, at a \$37.00 average cost per click, roughly 2.4× the account average. It was paused on 07/09/2026. Of its spend, \$126.26 went to three broad queries — tow truck online quote, towing cost and bare towing — which have since been excluded. In August, over ten days, the same campaign had returned leads at \$32.86. The structure, not the geography, is what failed: it was set loose on broad match with no negative list.



\$673.12 went to search terms that produced no leads

34 terms,

31% of the month's spend

, up from \$506.87 and 27% in August. Roughly

\$378.52 is clearly blockable

: competitor names (\$152.56 — nationwide towing number, nationwide towing dandenong, anytime towing, ace towing, magnet towing, racv roadside assist, planet towing melbourne, mendem towing service), price-shopping queries (\$111.35 — tow truck online quote, towing cost, how much is a tow truck cost, car towing cost), work the business doesn't do (\$95.28 — interstate vehicle transfer, heavy tow truck, accident allocation towing) and out-of-area towns (\$19.34 — sunbury towing). The rest is mostly local terms that simply had a quiet month and are worth keeping.



Broad metro terms took back budget share

54.8% of spend in September against 52.7% in August, at \$71.89 a lead. Reversing that two-point drift alone would have saved roughly \$25 a lead on the money involved. "towing service melbourne" and "car towing service near me" together consumed

45% of the entire month's budget

and returned 14 of 38 leads.



Conversion value still isn't tracked

Leads are counted but not valued, so we still cannot report revenue or return on ad spend. An average job value is all that's needed. This has been outstanding for six months and remains the single thing holding the reporting back — it is also what would settle whether a \$57 lead is good or bad, rather than merely dearer than last month.

Recommended next steps

- 1 Add the negative keyword list this week** — competitor names, price-shopping queries, interstate and heavy-haulage work, and out-of-area towns. Recovers roughly \$378 a month immediately and nothing in it has ever converted.
- 2 Decide the Yarra Valley campaign's future before restarting it** — either relaunch on exact match only with the negative list applied, or fold the Yarra Valley terms back into the main campaign, where "yarra valley towing" returns leads at \$26.53 against \$147.98 in the dedicated campaign. Restarting it unchanged would repeat September.
- 3 Fix the landing page behind "car towing service near me"** — Google rates its landing page experience below average, the only such flag in the account, on the keyword that now produces the account's dearest leads at volume. This is the highest-leverage single fix available.
- 4 Shift budget from metro to towns** — broad terms are 58% dearer per lead and took 55% of the budget. Moving even ten points of spend towards suburb terms is worth several leads a month at current rates.
- 5 Confirm the budget position** — the main campaign reads **\$65.00/day** today and the paused Yarra Valley campaign \$40.00/day. September averaged \$61.94 across its 29 serving days. Worth confirming \$65/day is the intended level for October before volume is read against it.
- 6 Set a conversion value** — six months in, this is the only thing standing between this report and genuine return-on-spend reporting.

● Ready to Rank

Vic. Haulage Co. · Google Ads performance · Apr–Sep 2026 · All figures AUD

Data pulled live from Google Ads on 03/10/2026. Fractional conversion counts reflect Google's attribution modelling.

Search-term figures cover the 68% of September spend (\$1,470.72 of \$2,166.27) that Google attributes to specific search queries; low-volume queries are withheld for privacy, so the zero-conversion total is a floor rather than the whole picture.